

Final Outcome Tier Record

CareerForge Day 7 — Engineering
Defence Board

Student: Vibhuti Uttarde | 3rd Year Diploma | Information Technology | Vidyalankar Polytechnic | Self-Assessment

Final Outcome Tier

[x] STRONG PASS	[] Pass	[] Revision Required	[] Incomplete
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Outcome Evidence Table

Capability	Evidence Considered	Outcome Note
Debugging	Day 1: 4 bugs found across port conflict, wrong env URL, 30s JWT expiry, and Content-Type header override. Founder assumption rejected. Fixed in commit 3fba0f8. Full workflow verified before and after with screenshots.	Strong — systematic, evidence-driven, no guessing. Screenshots and commit ID present.
Systems Reasoning	Day 2: PostgreSQL write latency identified as origin failure at log 10:01:10. All 4 competing hypotheses evaluated with specific log-line evidence. Causal chain walked from DB write to all 5 reported symptoms.	Strong — log sequence traced correctly. Symptoms separated from root cause with exact timestamps.
Readiness Verification	Day 3: 3 cascading .env blockers found on same code path. Critical workflow declared before touching anything. Demo blocked with evidence. 4 .env-only fixes applied. Remaining risk acknowledged (c_101 only tested).	Adequate — correct BLOCK decision. Gap: not all 4 candidates tested before declaring fix complete.
Ambiguity Ownership	Day 4: 5 ambiguities surfaced before any code written. 1 clarification question resolved 4 of them. v1 scoped to minimum safe implementation. AI full-module recommendation rejected with stated reasons.	Adequate — compliance risk surfaced correctly. Evaluator may probe eligibility enforcement depth.
AI Judgment	Day 5: 3 recommendations blocked (Redis, reconciliation, service split) with exact failure sequences. 1 modified (idempotency atomicity). 2 trusted. All decisions had stated evidence-based reasons.	Adequate — correct outcomes on all AI tasks. Failure-sequence evaluation habit was sometimes reactive, not proactive.
Pressure Prioritization	Day 6: Priority order held throughout — customer money safety first, root cause second, comms third, analytics last. Checkout paused T+01. Founder pressure acknowledged but not acted on. One mistake self-identified (banner vs FAQ).	Strong — decisions traceable to harm metrics. Tradeoffs stated with rationale. Real mistake acknowledged proactively.
Engineering Defense	Day 7: Full dossier with per-day evidence, capability scorecard, growth prescription with 4-week plan, and honest self-assessment of weakest area. No defensive framing used anywhere.	Adequate — written defense is strong. Live viva is the remaining unknown.

Strongest Demonstrated Capability

Capability: Evidence-based root cause identification across multiple problem types — debugging (Day 1), systems analysis (Day 2), product readiness (Day 3), and live incident response (Day 6).

Evidence: All four days show the same core pattern: declare the scope, reject surface framing, trace to the origin with specific evidence, act on the root not the symptom. The method transferred across code bugs, system logs, .env configuration, and live incident metrics.

Required Growth Area

Growth area: AI trust judgment — developing failure-sequence evaluation as a proactive first-move habit, not a reactive recovery step.

Evidence: Day 5 required manual reconstruction of the Redis crash scenario to identify the flaw. Day 4 required reading through a full AI spec before applying the scope filter. Both reached the correct outcome, but the evaluation was triggered by discovering a problem, not by applying a standard check upfront.

Final Student Summary

Vibhuti Uttarde completed the 6-day CareerForge Engineering Challenge as a 3rd Year Diploma IT student and demonstrated consistent evidence-based engineering judgment across debugging, systems analysis, readiness verification, ambiguity resolution, AI evaluation, and incident response.

The two most significant things that changed across this week: first, understanding that 'it works' and 'it is ready' are completely different standards — health checks and login passing is not evidence that the declared workflow functions (Day 3). Second, getting better at saying no to AI suggestions and founder pressure using evidence rather than instinct alone — and being able to state exactly why (Days 4, 5, and 6).

The clearest remaining gap is AI trust judgment as a proactive habit. The correct evaluations were reached, but the trigger was sometimes reactive. The 30-day growth plan targets this with a specific daily question: 'What breaks if this is wrong?' — applied before acting, not after.

Self-assessed outcome: Strong Pass. Evidence is present across all 6 days. Defense gaps are known and preparation notes are documented in the Capability Scorecard.